

KEYSTONE TALENT PARTNERS

Building an AI Operating System — Consultant Engagement Brief

For review by AI automation / agentic-workflow consultants ahead of our conversation

This brief gives you the context you need before we talk: who we are, how we operate today, what we want to build, and exactly what we will ask you to bring. Please read it in advance. We are not looking for a polished sales pitch — we want to see how you would translate these business problems into practical, affordable automation for a small, relationship-driven search and staffing firm working from a tight budget.

A guiding principle frames everything below: technology should amplify our relationships, not replace them. We do not want cold, impersonal automation. The point is to take research, drafting, routing, reminders, reporting, and other repetitive work off our people so they can spend more time with clients, candidates, and partners — and close more business.

1. Who We Are

Keystone Talent Partners is a boutique recruiting and staffing firm. We place talent across Accounting, Finance, Technology, Human Resources, Operations, Legal, and Executive Leadership, through direct hire, interim and fractional leadership, consulting and project staffing, and contract and contract-to-hire arrangements.

We have grown through referrals, reputation, and long-held relationships, and that model is still a genuine strength. What we lack is a proactive, disciplined, repeatable business-development engine — especially for our consulting, project-staffing, interim, fractional, and contract revenue. We want a practical AI operating system that generates more revenue activity without piling on headcount or software cost: surfacing leads, nurturing prospects and candidates, producing consistent marketing, tightening CRM discipline, cutting admin, and sharpening our daily focus.

Service Lines

Service line	What it covers
Consulting / project staffing	Our top growth priority. Consultants and project resources for transformation, accounting, finance, technology, HR, operations, and special initiatives.
Direct hire / permanent placement	Professional and leadership hiring across accounting, finance, technology, HR, operations, legal, and related disciplines.
Interim leadership	Interim CFO, Controller, HR, technology, and operations support during transitions, transformations, vacancies, or rapid growth.

Service line	What it covers
Fractional leadership	Part-time or embedded senior expertise for companies that need leadership without a full-time hire.
Contract / contract-to-hire	Flexible staffing for short-term, long-term, and conversion-based needs.

Where We Want to Grow

- Expand consulting, project staffing, interim, fractional, and contract revenue.
- Shift from referral-dependent to consistently proactive business development.
- Spot companies showing hiring demand, growth, turnover, transformation, or operational strain — and reach them first.
- Keep more regular, well-timed touchpoints with prospects, clients, candidates, and referral partners.
- Lean on AI to cut manual research, drafting, scheduling, tracking, and content production.

2. How We Operate Today

The table below consolidates our current workflows function by function — how each one runs now and where it breaks down. Hiring-signal / lead intelligence is the most consequential gap and is treated as a flagship build in Section 4.

Function (current maturity)	How it runs today	Bottlenecks & risks
Business development — manual / relationship-led	• Research target companies and decision-makers by hand • Notice hiring signals inconsistently • Draft outreach manually • Follow up from memory, calendar reminders, or CRM notes • Track activity across email, LinkedIn, CRM, and informal notes	• Uneven outbound cadence • Too much research time before any outreach • Missed follow-ups • Little visibility into which prospects are warm • Not enough lead flow for consulting / project staffing
Hiring-signal / lead intelligence — critical gap	• Relies on manual market awareness, referrals, LinkedIn activity, and occasional job-posting research • Open job orders on company sites are not systematically captured, categorized,	• A core revenue gap • No agent continuously watching career pages, job boards, company activity, press, funding/growth news, layoffs, or

Function (current maturity)	How it runs today	Bottlenecks & risks
	scored, or converted to outreach	leadership changes • BD stays reactive instead of proactive
Recruiting — partly standardized, still manual	• Review resumes and qualify candidates • Write candidate summaries and prepare submissions • Coordinate interviews and reference checks • Update Bullhorn	• Heavy administrative load • Formatting and summaries are time-consuming • Candidate marketing is inconsistent • CRM updates lag activity
Marketing — inconsistent, time-permitting	• Post to LinkedIn, send newsletters, market updates, candidate spotlights, and service-line content when time allows • Want to expand into Facebook, Instagram, and video	• No systematized calendar • Content competes with revenue work • Thought leadership underused for consulting / project-staffing growth
Client / candidate nurture — relationship-based, not automated	• Stay in touch with clients, prospects, candidates, and referral partners • Share market intelligence and check-ins	• Strong network but inconsistent cadence • High-value relationships go quiet too long • Need more segmented, timely outreach
Meeting notes / follow-up — manual	• Take notes on calls • Draft follow-up emails • Track action items • Update CRM	• Action items get scattered • Follow-up drafts take time • CRM documentation is inconsistent
Reporting / KPIs — developing	• Track activity, searches, candidates, client conversations, marketing, and pipeline	• Need clearer daily and weekly visibility • Need metrics tied to revenue activity and AI ROI

3. The Target Operating Model

We picture an AI operating system with one orchestration layer, one executive-assistant layer, and a set of specialized agents — practical, affordable, maintainable, and rolled out in phases so it pays back quickly. The roster below is ordered by priority.

Priority	Agent	Mission	Core outputs
Critical	Hiring-Signal / Lead Intelligence Agent	Mission-critical revenue agent. Continuously researches public sources for hiring signals and open job orders to create new BD leads.	• Career-page monitoring • Open-role detection • Job-board monitoring • Press/funding/growth/leadership research • Lead scoring • Outreach-angle recommendations • CRM lead creation/update
Critical	Business Development Agent	Turns lead intelligence into actionable outreach and follow-up.	• Company research • Decision-maker identification • Personalized email and LinkedIn drafts • Follow-up sequences • CRM notes
Highest	Atlas — AI Chief of Staff	Primary orchestrator. Prioritizes daily actions, coordinates agents, produces executive briefings, tracks revenue opportunities, and ensures follow-through.	• Daily revenue priorities • Follow-up recommendations • Agent coordination • Executive dashboard • Weekly activity summary • ROI tracking
Very high	Marketing Agent	Creates and organizes recurring thought leadership and service-line content across platforms.	• Monthly content calendar • LinkedIn/Facebook/Instagram posts • Newsletter drafts

Priority	Agent	Mission	Core outputs
			• Video topics/scripts • Candidate spotlights • Service-line campaigns
High	Ava — AI Executive Assistant	Meeting and follow-up assistant. Captures notes, summarizes decisions, drafts follow-ups, and routes action items.	• Meeting notes • Action items • Follow-up drafts • Calendar support • CRM update recommendations
High	Recruiting / Candidate Agent	Supports candidate processing, evaluation, marketing, and submissions.	• Resume summaries • Candidate profiles • Screening questions • Submission packages • Sanitized resumes • Candidate check-ins
High	CRM & Operations Agent	Keeps systems clean, structured, and useful.	• HubSpot/Bullhorn updates • Duplicate detection • Activity tracking • Follow-up reminders • SOP support
Medium	Analytics / KPI Agent	Tracks performance and business outcomes.	• Lead activity • Meetings booked • Touchpoints • Marketing cadence • Pipeline movement • ROI metrics

4. Flagship Build: The Hiring-Signal / Lead Intelligence Engine

This is the single most important component of the system because it feeds revenue directly. We need a reliable way to identify companies with open roles, growth activity, operational change, or hiring demand so we can open conversations before competitors do.

4.1 What it needs to achieve

- Produce a daily and weekly stream of business-development leads.
- Find companies hiring in our disciplines: Accounting, Finance, Technology, HR, Operations, Legal, C-Suite, and adjacent professional roles.
- Detect consulting, project-staffing, interim, fractional, contract-to-hire, and direct-hire opportunities.
- Prioritize companies likely to need outside recruiting or staffing support.
- Generate specific, non-generic outreach angles grounded in real public signals.
- Push qualified leads into HubSpot and/or Bullhorn with clear next steps.

4.2 Sources to monitor

- Company career pages and ATS job boards.
- LinkedIn company pages and public job postings.
- Job boards and aggregators, where legally and contractually permissible.
- Press releases, funding and M&A news, private-equity portfolio updates, leadership changes, expansions, relocations, and new offices.
- Industry news across our target verticals: private equity, healthcare, hospitality, real estate, financial services, technology, aviation, manufacturing, and distribution.
- Our own target-account, referral-partner, client/prospect, and PE-portfolio lists.

4.3 Fields to capture per lead

Every captured field serves the same purpose — to qualify, prioritize, route, and nurture the lead. Examples are illustrative.

Field	Example
Company name	ABC Healthcare
Website / source URL	Career page or article URL
Open role title	Controller / HRIS Manager / VP Finance
Function / discipline	Accounting, Finance, HR, Technology

Field	Example
Seniority level	Manager, Director, VP, C-Suite
Location / remote-hybrid status	Metro area, hybrid
Date found	YYYY-MM-DD
Hiring-signal type	Open job order, expansion, funding, leadership change
Why this matters	Multiple finance roles suggest a finance buildout
Suggested service fit	Project staffing, direct hire, interim controller
Likely buyer persona	CFO, COO, CHRO, CEO, PE operating partner
Decision-maker research needed	Find CFO and Head of HR
Priority score	A/B/C or 1-100
Recommended outreach angle	"Saw you're building out your finance team..."
CRM status	New lead / existing account / nurture
Next action	Draft outreach, research contact, add to campaign
Owner	Owner / recruiter / BD owner

4.4 How leads should be scored

Tier	Criteria
High	Multiple open roles in our disciplines; senior or critical roles; roles open 30+ days; PE-backed or high-growth company; signals of transformation, accounting cleanup, finance buildout, HR/technology implementation, compliance, or operational scaling.
Medium	One relevant professional role, a moderate growth signal, or target-industry fit with unclear urgency.
Low	Irrelevant role type, low-fit industry, stale posting, or insufficient buyer/contact information.

The agent must not blindly scrape and dump leads. For each one it should explain why the company is worth contacting and what the recommended angle is.

4.5 Guardrails

- Use lawful, platform-compliant collection. Respect terms of service, robots.txt where applicable, rate limits, and privacy requirements.
- Favor official career pages, public postings, licensed APIs, RSS feeds, Google Alerts, and approved data vendors.
- Don't collect sensitive personal data without a clear business reason and a compliant basis.
- A human reviews before any outreach is sent.
- Every lead links back to its source so we can verify the signal.

5. Tooling & Budget Approach

We're a small business on a constrained budget. Use what we already own wherever possible and avoid enterprise architecture unless the ROI is clear and measurable.

Layer	Tool(s)	Guidance
CRM / ATS	HubSpot and Bullhorn	Keep both. Decide whether HubSpot or Bullhorn is the primary home for BD lead intelligence, or whether leads stage elsewhere first.
Email / calendar	Microsoft Outlook / Office 365	Use for approved outreach, scheduling, and reminders.
Document storage	OneDrive / SharePoint	Use as the knowledge base and file repository if practical.
Meetings	Zoom / Microsoft Teams	Integrate Ava-style notes and action items.
AI engines	ChatGPT / OpenAI and Claude / Anthropic	Use for drafting, summarization, reasoning, scoring, and content.
Automation layer	Zapier, Make.com, or n8n	Choose on cost, maintainability, integrations, and reliability. Don't overengineer.
Lead research	Apollo.io, RocketReach, LinkedIn, company sites, public sources	Use existing subscriptions first; add paid tools only with clear ROI.
Staging database	Google Sheets, Microsoft Lists,	Use as a lead-review queue before

Layer	Tool(s)	Guidance
	Airtable, or HubSpot custom objects	pushing into the CRM.
Marketing scheduling	Native platform tools, HubSpot, Buffer, Metricool, or similar	Add only if needed for consistent posting and analytics.
Knowledge base / RAG	SharePoint/OneDrive plus a lightweight vector DB only if needed	Start simple; don't build costly infrastructure before validating the use case.

6. Rollout Sequence

Phase 1 focuses on revenue-generating workflows. Nice-to-have automations wait until the core BD and lead-intelligence engine is working.

Phase	Automation	What it unlocks
Phase 1 • Critical	Hiring-Signal / Lead Intelligence Agent	Finds companies with open roles and hiring signals, builds a lead queue, and recommends outreach angles — feeding the new-business pipeline.
Phase 1 • Critical	BD outreach workflow	Turns lead intelligence into personalized outreach drafts and follow-up sequences — converting research into meetings.
Phase 1 • Very high	Marketing content engine	Consistent LinkedIn, Facebook, Instagram, newsletter, video, and market-insight content — builds visibility and trust.
Phase 1-2 • High	Candidate nurture & marketing	Segments candidates, drafts check-ins, creates spotlights, identifies marketable consultants — supports placement velocity.
Phase 1-2 • High	Ava meeting notes + CRM follow-up	Captures notes and action items, drafts follow-ups, recommends CRM updates — cuts admin and prevents missed follow-through.
Phase 2 • High	Recruiting submission automation	Resume summaries, submissions, screening questions, branded/sanitized resumes —

Phase	Automation	What it unlocks
		improves speed and consistency.
Phase 2 • High	Executive dashboard	Daily priorities, open searches, BD activity, marketing cadence, candidate pipeline, KPI summary — improves focus and accountability.

7. What We're Asking You to Prepare

This section pulls together everything we want from you — before, during, and (if selected) after the interview. Finalists may be asked to complete a paid discovery sprint before implementation.

7.1 Before the interview — a short written response (max two pages)

1. The three highest-value opportunities you see after reading this brief.
2. How you would design the Hiring-Signal / Lead Intelligence Agent.
3. What you would build in the first 30 days.
4. Which tools you would use, and why.
5. What you would need from us to validate your recommendations.

7.2 Come ready to discuss

1. Map our current workflows from the information here and flag anything missing you'd need to validate.
2. Identify the top five automation opportunities, ranked by ROI and implementation difficulty.
3. Recommend the AI architecture for Atlas, Ava, the Hiring-Signal / Lead Intelligence Agent, and the other specialized agents.
4. Propose a low-budget tech stack that maximizes existing tools and minimizes new software.
5. Recommend a 30/60/90-day implementation plan, including quick wins in the first 30 days.
6. Estimate effort, cost range, dependencies, maintenance, and expected ROI.
7. Identify compliance, security, data-quality, and human-approval guardrails.
8. Explain how the system improves over time without expensive model retraining.

7.3 Finalists — a 15-minute whiteboard session

Conversational, not a generic sales deck. We want to see how you think, prioritize, and turn business problems into practical automation. Cover:

- Current-workflow assessment and the major bottlenecks.
- Top five automation opportunities, with ROI rationale.

- Proposed architecture for Atlas, Ava, the Hiring-Signal / Lead Intelligence Agent, BD Agent, Marketing Agent, Recruiting Agent, CRM/Ops Agent, and KPI Agent.
- Recommended low-budget tech stack and why.
- 30/60/90-day plan with quick wins.
- Estimated cost, effort, timeline, dependencies, risks, and expected impact.
- Success metrics and a maintenance plan.

7.4 If selected — paid discovery-sprint deliverables

- Current-state workflow map.
- Future-state AI operating-system architecture.
- Detailed design for the Hiring-Signal / Lead Intelligence Agent.
- Top five automation opportunities with ROI estimates.
- Recommended tech stack with cost-conscious options.
- Integration plan for HubSpot, Bullhorn, Microsoft 365, SharePoint/OneDrive, LinkedIn, Apollo.io, RocketReach, ChatGPT, and Claude.
- 30/60/90-day implementation roadmap.
- Risk, compliance, privacy, and maintenance plan.
- Budget estimate and implementation effort.
- Success-metrics dashboard framework.

8. How We'll Evaluate You

8.1 Questions we'll explore together

1. After reading this brief, what are the three highest-value opportunities to improve our business in the next 90 days, and why?
2. How would you design the Hiring-Signal / Lead Intelligence Agent so it consistently finds usable leads without creating a pile of low-quality data?
3. If this were your business and every dollar came out of your own pocket, what would you build first, postpone, and avoid?
4. How would Atlas, Ava, and the specialized agents work together day to day?
5. How would you integrate HubSpot, Bullhorn, Microsoft 365, LinkedIn, Apollo.io, RocketReach, SharePoint, ChatGPT, and Claude without overcomplicating the architecture?
6. How do you ensure security, privacy, compliance, source traceability, and human approval before any client/candidate communication?

7. Tell us about a comparable automation project you built: the business problem, what you built, and the measurable results.
8. What would your first 30 days look like if we hired you?

8.2 Scorecard

Criterion	Weight	What strong looks like
Business understanding	25%	Understands recruiting, staffing, consulting/project staffing, BD, referrals, candidate/client relationships, and revenue priorities.
Lead-intelligence / hiring-signal strategy	20%	Can design a practical system to find open roles and hiring signals from public sources and convert them into BD opportunities.
Workflow design	20%	Can map current workflows, find bottlenecks, and prioritize high-ROI automations.
Technical architecture	15%	Recommends affordable, maintainable tools and integrations without overengineering.
Communication / documentation	10%	Explains complex ideas simply and documents workflows in plain English.
ROI & practicality	10%	Focuses on time savings, revenue, adoption, and budget discipline.

9. What Success Looks Like

- A working lead-intelligence engine that surfaces relevant companies with hiring signals and open roles.
- More qualified BD touchpoints each week.
- More consistent consulting / project-staffing outreach.
- A repeatable marketing cadence across relevant channels.
- Better candidate nurture and candidate marketing.
- Less admin time on research, drafting, notes, and CRM updates.
- Improved HubSpot / Bullhorn data quality.
- A daily/weekly Atlas dashboard that prioritizes revenue-generating activity.

- Clear ROI: meetings booked, new client conversations, pipeline created, time saved, and placements generated.

A closing note: come with practical, budget-conscious recommendations. We're small and want to move quickly. The best solution isn't the most complex one — it's the one that grows revenue activity, saves time, strengthens relationships, and can realistically be built and maintained.